

MANAGING UP

The board does not need you to have solved it.

How to take a problem upward without sounding like an excuse.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

It needs you to have thought before you came up.

THE CASCADE

How a legitimate problem becomes an excuse.



WHAT YOU SEE

You take the problem up exactly as it reached you...



THE MECHANISM

...no number, no options, with the reason for the delay...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and you become the manager who brings problems, not solutions.

Whoever comes up with a raw problem is read as someone who does not know what to do.

THE FORK

What the room needs in thirty seconds.

THIRTY SECONDS

01

How much this is costing, in a number.

02

How long until it becomes irreversible.

03

What you recommend, and why.

Without those three, the meeting becomes an investigation instead of a decision.

THE METHOD

The packaged problem, four parts.

01 **THE FACT**

what happened, no adjectives and no hunt for a culprit

02 **THE COST**

in money, time, client or risk, always with a number

03 **THE OPTIONS**

two or three, with what is gained and lost in each

04 **THE RECOMMENDATION**

your choice, signed, even if the call belongs to someone else

Fifteen minutes of preparation completely change how you are read in the room.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Change the form and change the reading.

01 • THE FACT

Awaiting approval.

switch to getting approval, and the agenda is yours again

02 • THE COST

Depending on that team.

switch to agreeing with that team, with a date set

03 • THE
OPTIONS

I received no answer.

switch to I chased twice, and I escalate today

04 • THE
RECOMMENDATION

The scenario changed.

switch to we did not foresee this, and here is the adjustment

TWO MODELS

Two ways to go up with a problem.

THE COMMON MODEL

Dumping

Explains why it did not work

Speaks in general, with no number

Waits for the room to decide alone

Leaves with no date and no owner

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Packaging

Explains what was done so far

Brings cost and timing in numbers

Brings options and a recommendation

Leaves with a decision and next step

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three classic mistakes.

01 **Warning when nothing can be done anymore.**

- the size of the problem matters less than the timing of the warning.

02 **Naming the guilty team in front of everyone.**

- you win the argument and lose the next collaboration.

03 **Bringing only good news for months.**

- when the bad one arrives, nobody will trust your filter.

Credit upstairs is built by warning early, not by always being right.

THE CHAIN

The verb test.

01

Read your presentation and mark the passive verbs.



02

Awaiting, depending, not received, not prioritized.



03

Each one is a responsibility you left outside.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Five minutes reviewing verbs changes how the whole room reads you.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to prepare the next trip upstairs.



STEP 01

Put a number on the cost before any slide.

with no number, the talk becomes opinion against opinion



STEP 02

Bring two options, with the trade off spelled out.

whoever brings options joins the decision, whoever brings problems watches



STEP 03

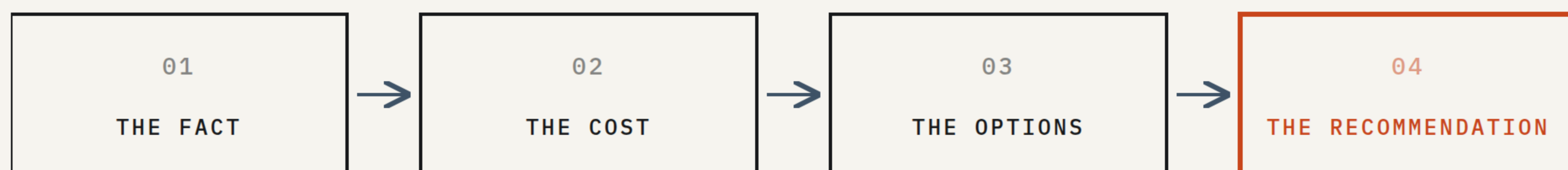
Run the verb test before you send the material.

and swap every passive for an action of yours with a date

Your edge is not warning that the knife is blunt, it is arriving with it sharp.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Packaged Problem, in the order that matters.



**A dumped problem becomes an excuse. A
packaged problem becomes a decision.**

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

before your next meeting with the board.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA